

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

2025 Year-in-Review Evaluation
01/01/2025 to 12/31/2025
Document Status: Completed
Evaluated By MIN,STEVE KYUNG

Employment Details

Person Number	001572592	Department	150590 Streaming Kafka
Location	1 OPTUM CIRCLE--EDEN PRAIRIE	Division	46235 DV Chief Data Office (CDaO)
Job	Sr Software Engineer	Manager	MOCKUS,MICHAEL J

Overall Performance Rating

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Overall Rating	4 - Meets Expectations
Comments	Luke's performance was strong this year with emphasis on growing beyond his usual technology stack. Luke remains the example for operational excellence I wish for the team. His deep knowledge of the platform was pivotal in decommissioning efforts and remains so. He was also able to leverage this knowledge to help him deliver functionality such as schema registry. His input is highly valued as we continue on our new evolution of the Kafka platform.

Complete or View Self-Reflection

JOHNSON,LUCAS AVERY BOYD

Reflecting on the goals you had for this year, what were your key accomplishments?

Operational Excellence

High availability and reliability of the Kafka platform is our highest priority. This year we have gone through a lot of changes to our customer support structure. Managing all customer queries through ServiceNow or support intake has had its challenges but has allowed us to organize tickets to provide measurable support to our customers. This year I have contributed to and written various playbooks for the team

to follow for a variety of common support duties. One of my most proud operational efforts this year is the creation of the `hcc-dp-utilites` repository. In this repo I have created various utility scripts that automate common ops tasks. These scripts speed up otherwise tedious tasks to increase team efficiency and decrease human error. One such example is the creation of cross-namespace produce ACLs, which is a common task requested by our customers. Outside of bi-weekly support days, we have our primary on-call rotation. I think this year has seen some of the lowest volume of platform alerts overall. When alerts do happen, they have been remediated in a timely manner, with minimal need for escalation. Continued contributions to our Grafana dashboards and alerts, by myself and the rest of the team, help to ensure our metrics and thresholds are accurate. This maintains a balance of both security and stability of our platform and the sanity of the engineers on-call. The final operational effort is of course security vulnerabilities, a constant effort to maintain compliance for our platform.

Engineering

My main engineering efforts this year are the completion of the GCP Kafka migration to HCP Console, the adoption of Confluent Schema Registry, and various miscellaneous smaller efforts such as sandbox workstation contributions and PRM collaboration.

- The GCP Migration to console was completed on March 20th of this year. We had a few large customers which needed to wait until peak season was over. Many of the remaining customers also required special functionality: by-the-cluster migrations. This required a re-work of much of the automation to seamlessly migrate these large final workloads. In total, the migration included 171 namespaces, housing 208 clusters and 140,536 resources. In addition to the 171 namespace that were successfully migrated, there were many namespaces that were deemed no longer used and were therefore appropriately cleaned up in coordination with owners. The migration was ultimately a big success. There was no negative customer impact, which is a huge win especially when considering the scale of resources being handled.
- My contributions toward Confluent Schema Registry were my second main engineering accomplishment of the year. Being a new product for our team there was not a shortage of new things to learn. One of the first items that I contributed to was the mirroring of the `_schemas` topic from our current registry to Confluent for all environments (lab/nonprod/prod). There was a lot of discovery that was necessary in this process as it was the first time working with these new clusters. Networking and new broker commands were just some of the challenges faced on the way to an ultimately successful effort. My most significant contribution to the Confluent Schema Registry effort was the mirroring of ACLs. I was a major stakeholder in the design, planning and implementation of this effort. It ultimately involved determining which topic ACL access needed

to be transferred, creating automation to do so and finally executing that automation and verifying accuracy. This was no small task when it came to the number of moving parts. From the legacy agents/gitops/linting in the KaaS-Prod world to the agents/operators/RBAC in the Console space (Kafka Alpha and GCP) there was a lot to coordinate and iteratively test. Once the core functionality was in place, automation was developed to manipulate the appropriate resources to provide seamless access for our customer migrating to the new CFK endpoints.

- Other notable contributions this year include sandbox workstation development as well as PRM troubleshooting. Working directly with the PRM team on various inconsistencies we were seeing with our agents and some general query issues was important to maintain platform functionality for our customer's and the ongoing migrations.

Growth

This year, even more so than previous years, has been one of monumental development for me. I feel that I was able to use confidence gained in my engineering abilities to help plan and execute on large initiatives such as the adoption of Confluent Schema Registry and the GCP to HCP Console Migration. By no means did I complete these tasks alone, but I feel I played a leadership role in them. I, along with the rest of the team, am also growing in my adoption of AI. Most obviously in the work toward completion of the AI Dojo Course by the end of the year.

Agile Delivery

I have consistently contributed to the team's working cycles throughout the year. I was able to complete most assigned task within the assigned sprint, leading to a high level of predictability from myself. I have provided flexibility and collaboration with other team members to help them in completing assigned tasks when help may have been needed. I have also played a large role in story planning and refinement. Making sure that stories are clear and contain ample detail to help the assigned engineer make progress with as little interference as possible. Engaging in bi-weekly planning/story pointing also helps our team to be organized and contributes to a reasonable amount of work each sprint cycle.

Deliver Quality the First Time, Every Time

Delivery quality products is most important but can be hard to balance with

deadlines and evolving priorities. Through this challenging balance, I believe our team thrives. Our teamwork and ability to lean on one another enables us to deliver quality products to our customers. We all contribute to the collaborative environment that is so important to this team. Everyone is willing to lend a hand when asked and provide a second look at items in the way of code reviews and comments. It is important that we delivery quality all the time to maintain trust with all our platform users. The product that we offer needs to be reliable, secure and enjoyable to interact with. Whether its through daily customer support or delivering new features, I am always putting quality at the forefront. Working toward only positive customer feedback and no unplanned downtime or data loss.

What challenges did you face and how did you develop?

I think the most notable challenge that I, and much of the team, has faced this year is the constant security vulnerability battle. We all recognize it is important to be secure, but there are many flaws to the system which decrease our productivity. It has been a long process, but we have all done our part to remediate what we can while also continuing to develop and deliver on our highest priorities.

I think another challenge is the rapid adoption of AI. While it is a good advancement, it is always a bit difficult to adapt to new technology. Taking the AI Dojo course has helped in creating an understanding for the power and abilities that AI can bring to augment our daily work.

What do you want to continue to work towards in the coming year?

I want to continue to develop my skills as a leader on the team. I want to continue to take initiative and be able to provide my opinion on decisions where appropriate. I want to work on being even more flexible, take challenges in stride and use them as growth opportunities. I want to continue learning and leveraging new AI technologies to help our team accelerate. Finally, I want to continue the great collaboration that this team has proven to offer.

2025 Goals

Agile Delivery

Description The growth goals focus on achieving a high predictability score for code churn, ensuring that code changes are reliable and consistent. Additionally, there is an emphasis on establishing a baseline for feature cycle time by the end of Q2 and working towards improving this cycle time by the end of the year.

Success Criteria

Agile Delivery Goals

Code Predictability/Churn

- Achieve an 80% predictability score

Feature Cycle Time

- Establish a feature cycle baseline by the end of Q2
- Improve feature cycle time by the end of the year

Status Not started

Comments

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Performance Rating	4 - Meets Expectations
Comments	Luke consistently delivers on time

Deliver Quality the First Time, Every Time

Description I commit to excellence in all my work, making Quality my top priority. I constantly look for ways to improve and go above and beyond for those we serve. I believe everyone plays a part in maintaining Quality, and together, we create a culture where excellence is the norm and Quality is the result of our teamwork.

Success Criteria

Review the [Quality Goal Guide](#) and work with your manager to

create specific, quantifiable success criteria for you in your role.
Use this section to record the actions you will take.

Status Not started
Comments

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Performance Rating	4 - Meets Expectations
Comments	I can always trust Luke's deliverables to be of high quality, he takes great care into ensuring his work is validated.

Engineering

Description The engineering goals emphasize the importance of regularly updating and deploying codebases to ensure they remain current. Increasing the percentage of automated testing is crucial, with goals tailored to each team's current coverage. Additionally, there is a strong focus on enhancing productivity through AI, ensuring its adoption across all engineers and piloting its use for feature creation, code delivery, and improving code quality.

Success Criteria

Engineering Goals

Regular Deployment

- Update and deploy codebases on a regular cadence
- Reduce image age from TBA to TBD

Automated Testing

- Increase the percentage of functionality automated
- Tailor automation goals to each team based on current coverage

Productivity Enhancements Using AI

- Normalize AI adoption across the team
- Pilot AI for code delivery and improving code quality

Status Not started

Comments

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Performance Rating	4 - Meets Expectations
Comments	Luke excelled at delivering critical functionality at scale.

Growth

Description The growth goals aim to establish team-wide objectives for obtaining specific certifications and training, while also tracking the submission and approval of ideas, such as the number of architects and AI training sessions. Personalized growth goals will be set for each team member, acknowledging that these will differ significantly. Additionally, there is a focus on ensuring that a substantial portion of the team becomes proficient in the new tools being adopted, such as Kafka Warpstream, Confluent Schema Registry, Striim, and Debezium.

Success Criteria

Growth Goals

Certifications/Training Courses

- Complete AI Training Courses

Team Specific/Individual Specific Goals

- Incorporate AI workflows, and develop integrating AI pipelines.
- Become fluent in Warpstream architecture and support.
- Become fluent in Confluent Schema Registry architecture and support

Status Not started

Comments

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Performance Rating	4 - Meets Expectations
Comments	Luke excelled at moving away from his typical "onprem" tech stack into the cloud this year.

Operational Excellence

Description The operational goals focus on ensuring high application availability and reliability, aiming for top performance ratings. There is a significant emphasis on reducing the number of alerts compared to the previous year, striving for noticeable improvement. Consistently meeting service level agreements for support tickets and customer support is a priority. The tracking method for reducing common vulnerabilities and exposures will be adapted to ensure effective management. Additionally, maintaining compliance with security standards is crucial, with metrics influenced by specific technologies like CDC and Kafka.

Success Criteria

Operational Goals

Application Availability

- Achieve HAD Score of 99% for a 5 rating
- Achieve HAD Score of 95% for a 4 rating
- Achieve HAD Score of 85% for a 3 rating

Alert Reduction

- Reduce alerts by 50% compared to the previous year
- Adjust Year-over-Year (YoY) to fit totals

SLA on Support Tickets/Customer Support

- Meet SLA 95% of the time

CVEs MBO

- Adjust based on new method of tracking CVE reduction

Security MBO - Golden Image Compliance

- Significant progress into reducing Golden Image CVEs

Status Not started
Comments

MIN,STEVE KYUNG	Manager
Performance Rating	5 - Exceeds Expectations
Comments	Luke cares deeply about the customer experience and is the most knowledgeable about the wide breadth of operational processes our team relies upon daily. He fully understands the ownership and is frequently first to help other team members in challenges we face operationally.

Employee Comments